Someone who has worked closely with me for fourteen years is my manager, Vinod Naidu. He is more like my family and all the sacrifices, spending time away from his family for my work, has been special, so a big thank you to your family as well, for giving so much time for my work with Vinod.

In my schooldays, when I performed well, the media backed me a lot. You continue to do that till this morning. Thank you so much to all the media, for supporting me and appreciating my performances. It surely had a positive effect on me. Thank you so much to all the photographers as well, for those wonderful captured moments will stay with me for the rest of my life, so to all the photographers a big thank you.

I know my speech is getting a bit too long, but this is the last thing I want to say … I want to … I want to thank all the people here who've flown in from various parts of the world and supported me endlessly, whether I scored a zero or I scored a hundred-plus, whatever. Your support was so dear to me and it meant a lot to me.

Whatever you've done for me – I know I've met so many guys who've fasted for me, prayed for me, done all sorts of things for me – you know, without all that, life wouldn't have been like this for me. I want to thank you from the bottom of my heart, and also say that time has flown by rather quickly, but the memories that you have left with me will always be with me for ever and ever, especially 'Sachin, Sachin'. That will reverberate in my ears … till I stop breathing.

Thank you very much. If I've, if I've missed out on saying something, missed out on a few names, I hope you understand. Goodbye.

Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai
16 November 2013